On the other hand, both government and private analysts remain wary of the prospect of an increased role for the "people's currency" in global financial and trade markets, and recognize that Chinese preferences on currency levels may not necessarily benefit India. On his return from the Seoul G20 in November 2010, Prime Minister Singh was uncharacteristically blunt, according to an article in the *Times of India:* "The relation between surplus countries and deficit countries is not a technical issue… . The international financial mechanism is essentially a power mechanism." The reporter further clarified: "Weighing in on the China-U.S. currency war, the PM essentially said China could not absolve itself of responsibility in restoring the global balance."[219]

In 2011, then–RBI Governor Duvvari Subbarao complained that an undervalued RMB was hurting India.[220] In mid-2015, Saran wrote that the RMB "could not" become a reserve currency so long as China remained authoritarian.[221] Senior economics commentator P. Vaidyanathan Iyer concluded that local currency trade among BRICS would have more benefits for China than for India.[222] China's difficulties with gradual financial liberalization, such as the stock market and exchange rate troubles of mid-2015, have been greeted with scarcely disguised glee in some quarters in India, as Mumbai financiers hoped that Chinese investors would pull their funds out of China and place them in the more mature and stable Indian capital markets. RBI Governor Rajan, nonetheless, felt the need to come to China's defense.[223]

Even pro-BRICS think tank director Mathur avoids endorsing RMB internationalization as a desirable collective response to U.S. dollar hegemony and has been guardedly critical of the emerging "Chinese financial architecture" that has created China's outside option. Mathur notes that the AIIB has "diffused the energy being put into the BRICS bank," and that China's OBOR initiative to fund infrastructure development in Central Asia could "force smaller economies to adopt a Renminbi-based financial system," not an outcome that would be helpful to Indian multinational business.[224]

Recently, and particularly under the assertive Chinese President Xi and equally forceful Indian Prime Minister Modi, both economic ties and tit-for-tat political maneuvering have intensified. In early 2014, Japanese Prime Minister Shinzo Abe promised $32 billion in foreign direct investment